

Congregation Bible Study Answers - August 17-23, 2026

Congregation Bible Study Answers — Week of August 17-23, 2026

Walk Courageously With God (wcg) | Chapter 4: Abraham - The First Man to Wage a Righteous War

Each answer is written as a meeting comment, about 20-30 seconds when spoken. The focus is on giving usable answers, not conducting notes.

Opening Discussion

1. In what ways did Abraham show courage?

Answer option 1: Abraham showed courage by acting quickly to rescue Lot, even though Lot's own choices had put him near Sodom. Abraham did not let resentment or fear control him. He gathered his trained men and pursued four powerful kings. His courage was not selfish or aggressive; it was moved by loyalty, family love, and trust that Jehovah would support what was right.

Answer option 2: What impresses me is that Abraham was more of a shepherd than a soldier, yet he did what the situation required. He did not say, "That is not my strength." He saw a need, knew what Jehovah would approve, and acted. That teaches me that courage is not limited to what feels natural. Jehovah can help us do what love requires.

Dig Deeper

2. What archaeological evidence supports the accuracy of this account? (w89 7/1 5 ¶4-6 ¶1)

Answer option 1: The account fits what is known about ancient rulers, military campaigns, and alliances in that period. Archaeology has shown that cities and routes in the region existed, and that kings did form coalitions and fight over territory and tribute. So the account does not read like a legend. It fits the historical world in which Abraham lived.

Answer option 2: This strengthens my confidence in the Bible. The details about places, kings, routes, and warfare are not vague storytelling. They fit real history. That matters because our faith is not based on myths. Jehovah preserved a record that can stand up to investigation, and that helps us speak about the Bible with

confidence.

3. What geographical evidence supports the Bible's description of Sodom and Gomorrah? (it "Salt Sea" ¶6) A

Answer option 1: The Bible describes the area near Sodom as fertile and well-watered before Jehovah destroyed it. The region around the Salt Sea still gives evidence that parts of the area could support vegetation, including date palms. That supports the description of Lot choosing what looked like an attractive and productive place to live.

Answer option 2: The geography makes Lot's choice easier to understand. He was not choosing something obviously bad on the surface. The land looked appealing. That is a warning for me. A place or opportunity can look materially attractive and still be spiritually dangerous if it puts me close to corrupt influences.

4. Melchizedek was king and priest of Salem. Where was Salem? (it "Salem")

Answer option 1: Salem is generally understood to be the city later known as Jerusalem. So when Melchizedek came out as king of Salem and priest of the Most High God, the account connects Abraham with a place that later became very important in Jehovah's purpose.

Answer option 2: I like how this small detail points forward. Salem later becomes connected with Jerusalem, kingship, priesthood, and worship of Jehovah. So the meeting between Abraham and Melchizedek was not just a polite greeting after battle. It fits into the bigger picture of how Jehovah would develop his purpose.

5. How was Melchizedek a prophetic type of Jesus? (it "High Priest" ¶27-28) B

Answer option 1: Melchizedek was both a king and a priest, and the Bible does not record his priesthood as coming through a family line. In that way, he pictured Jesus, who serves as both King and High Priest by Jehovah's appointment. Jesus' priesthood is superior and lasting, not based on descent from Aaron.

Answer option 2: This helps me appreciate Jehovah's wisdom. Long before Jesus came to earth, Jehovah included in Abraham's history a living pattern that would help us understand Christ's role. Jesus is not only a ruler with power; he is also a compassionate High Priest who can help us approach Jehovah.

Reflect on the Lessons

6. Abraham allowed Lot to take the best of the land. How can we imitate Abraham in our dealings with our family, our fellow believers, and others? C

Answer option 1: We can imitate Abraham by not insisting on our rights or always taking the best for ourselves. In family life or in the congregation, peace is often protected when we are willing to yield. Abraham showed that a generous spirit is not weakness. It takes courage to trust Jehovah enough to be unselfish.

Answer option 2: Picture C makes the point practical. Giving up a preferred seat, yielding in a decision, or putting someone else's need first may seem small, but it reflects Abraham's spirit. He believed Jehovah could bless him without his having to grasp for every advantage. That is a courageous way to treat others.

7. What do we learn from Abraham's willingness to rescue his nephew?

Answer option 1: Abraham's willingness to rescue Lot teaches me not to hold back help just because someone made an unwise choice. Lot had chosen to live near Sodom, but Abraham still acted when he was in danger. Love does not say, "You caused this, so deal with it yourself." Abraham showed loyal, active concern.

Answer option 2: I also learn that courage can be motivated by mercy. Abraham did not go to war for glory, land, or wealth. He went because his nephew needed rescue. That helps me examine my motives. Christian courage should not be harsh or self-promoting; it should be guided by love and a desire to protect others spiritually.

8. In what other ways might you imitate the courage shown by Abraham in this account?

Answer option 1: I can imitate Abraham by acting when someone needs help instead of waiting for someone else to do it. That may mean encouraging a discouraged brother, defending someone who is treated unfairly, or helping a family member spiritually. Abraham did not just feel concern for Lot. He took practical action.

Answer option 2: I can also imitate Abraham by not letting fear of powerful opposition stop me from doing what is right. He faced kings who looked stronger than he was. Today, opposition may come from work, school, relatives, or public opinion. Abraham reminds me that Jehovah's approval matters more than the size of the opposition.

Meditate on the Bigger Picture

9. What does this account teach me about Jehovah?

Answer option 1: This account teaches me that Jehovah notices courageous, unselfish action. Abraham acted to rescue Lot, and Jehovah responded by blessing him through Melchizedek. Jehovah is not indifferent when his servants take risks to do what is right. He sees the faith behind the action and can strengthen and bless his loyal ones.

Answer option 2: It also teaches me that Jehovah can give victory in situations that look uneven. Abraham's household force was small compared with the armies he pursued, but Jehovah's blessing mattered more than numbers. That gives me confidence. When I face something beyond my ability, Jehovah is not limited by what I lack.

10. How does this account tie in with Jehovah's purposes?

Answer option 1: Satan wanted to destroy the nation that would come through Abraham, but Jehovah protected Abraham and his family line. The rescue of Lot also shows that Jehovah was still moving his purpose forward despite violence, war, and bad choices by humans. Nothing could stop the promised offspring from eventually coming.

Answer option 2: The account also points forward to Jesus. Melchizedek helps us understand Jesus as both King and High Priest, and Abraham's righteous warfare contrasts with the spiritual warfare Christians fight today. So the account is not isolated history. It helps us see Jehovah's purpose moving toward Christ and the Kingdom.

11. What would I like to ask Abraham or Lot in the resurrection?

Answer option 1: I would like to ask Abraham what gave him courage when he heard Lot had been taken captive. Did he feel afraid when he counted his men and thought about the armies he would face? I would like to hear how his trust in Jehovah helped him move from concern to action.

Answer option 2: I would like to ask Lot what he learned from being rescued. Did that experience make him think differently about living near Sodom? It would be interesting to hear his honest reflection, because it could help us understand how material choices and spiritual dangers can become connected.

Verified source pages

- English meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-August-17-23-2026/>

- English book study: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/books/walk-courageously-with-god/patriarchs-to-time-of-judges/abraham-first-man-to-wage-a-righteous-war/>